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Navigating the new globalization crisis through innovation and change management: An examination of the STRA.TECH.MAN-R.A.S.I. framework

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Navigating the new globalization crisis through innovation and change management: An examination of the STRA.TECH.MAN–R.A.S.I. framework

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Abstract

This chapter presents the STRA.TECH.MAN–R.A.S.I. framework in response to various global crises currently unfolding, including COVID-19, climate change, and the Russo-Ukrainian war. By combining the dimensions of Strategy, Technology, and Management (STRA.TECH.MAN) with those of Resilience, Adaptability, Sustainability, and Inclusiveness (R.A.S.I.), this approach addresses immediate priorities in today's turbulent world. The framework offers an integrative theoretical model to guide businesses through innovation and change management in the face of significant global transformations. We argue that our proposed scorecard, accessible and applicable to organizations of varied scales and nature, paves the way for effective crisis management under the prevailing global crisis conditions. Conceptual in nature, this theoretical proposal underscores potential avenues for future research.

Keywords: New globalization, Innovation, Change Management, Crisis Management, STRA.TECH.MAN–R.A.S.I. Scorecard, Resilience, Adaptability, Sustainability, Inclusiveness

1. Introduction

The world is currently experiencing a comprehensive transformation and reorganization, catalyzed by a series of interconnected crises. A burgeoning body of

scholarship posits that we are transitioning into a new phase of globalization, seen as a significant restructuring and expansion of the preceding global status quo, underscored by worldwide upheavals and disruptions. This context lays the groundwork for a multitude of examples exemplifying this new phase of globalization.

For instance, authors such as Strohmer et al. (2020) perceive this "new globalization" as a global hiatus and repolarization, while others like Nobis (2017) see it as the emergence of new socioeconomic and cultural power centers. Bhattacharya et al. (2017) interpret it as a reshaped multipolarity. Similarly, Briones et al. (2019) frame the new globalization as the reshaping of protectionism in response to globalization.

This evolutionary shift compels us to reevaluate and alter our expectations from both national constituents and the array of organizations—spanning from local to transnational—which play a crucial role in steering the prevalent courses of globalization (Held & McGrew, 2007). While Rodrik (2011) argues that the global system faces a "trilemma," Vlados and Chatzinikolaou (2021) counter by asserting that the new globalization necessitates a global situation that balances the trilemma's three elements—democracy, globalization, and national sovereignty—dynamically and simultaneously.

The substantial transformations we perceive today seem to have sprung from the 2008 shock, representing the structural maturity that had built up in prior periods. This period was when the transformation from the previous phase of globalization began, leading to maturation, destabilization, and transformation (Vlados, 2019b provides a detailed exploration of the phases of the post-WWII world economy). In particular, the 2008 shock marked a significant shift in this transition, as the deflation of the financial bubble triggered widespread socioeconomic unrest. Consequently, by the 2010s, a deeply transformed global landscape emerged. Regrettably, this evolving landscape

appears to provide constrained opportunities and diminished growth velocities, diverging from prior globalization stages, thus exhibiting heightened volatility compared to the near past (Duménil & Lévy, 2016).

Beyond the broad socioeconomic implications of the noted significant realignment, Bhattacharya et al.'s (2017) theoretical study also provides certain guidelines for developing business models in response to contemporary globalization at the micro-level and within the business landscape. The study asserts that global organizations in the 21st century must charter three main courses: intensified customer engagement, decentralization of processes, and selective centralization of certain global functions. The increased customer focus emanates from today's digitally connected consumers, pushing beyond transactional relations to a realm of real-time, platform-based service. Moreover, the study underscores the need for decentralization in response to the upsurge and redefinition of national protectionist policies. It promotes the idea of empowering local branches with the autonomy to flexibly operate using Industry 4.0 technologies. Bhattacharya et al. correlate selective centralization to a firm's ability to amalgamate specific, efficiently operated functions into single business units. This strategy aims to control organizational costs and enhance digital competencies. However, their assessment is mainly angled towards large, systematically organized firms, thereby leaving an exploratory void regarding smaller firms and more flexible business models in various sectors.

Our current theoretical analysis seeks to fill this void. In this chapter, we delve into the mechanisms of an organization's internal response mechanisms to substantial shifts in the global environment over time. Our goal is to scrutinize if we could systematically trace this ongoing evolution, with a spotlight specifically on the recent developments

regarded as pivotal for ensuring survival and facilitating growth in this freshly emerging external landscape.

We also consider the effects of recent crises, including COVID-19 and the Russo-Ukrainian war, which have fast-tracked the fourth industrial revolution and the energy transition respectively (Allam et al., 2022; Dhawan et al., 2022). These crises are mutually reinforcing and evolutionarily interconnected, propelling the entire global socioeconomic system towards a novel phase of globalization. In this setting, all participants must innovatively respond to the crisis by considering their external environment from a multilevel perspective—simultaneously considering macro, meso, and micro aspects (Dopfer, 2011; Vlados & Chatzinikolaou, 2020). This chapter primarily concentrates on the micro-level, aiming to delineate a methodology that encapsulates the efforts of organizations to innovate and navigate the transformative reality they find themselves in (Bremmer, 2014; Vlados et al., 2021).

We put forth a theoretical framework poised to analytically connect the organizational nucleus of "Strategy-Technology-Management" (STRA.TECH.MAN) with the emerging priorities of Resilience, Adaptability, Sustainability, and Inclusiveness, collectively referred to as R.A.S.I. These principles have surfaced as urgent organizational requirements in our profoundly altered global context (World Economic Forum, 2018). We posit that this holistic view of organizational evolution is vital for stimulating innovation and managing change efficiently in this restructured epoch of globalization.

Our chapter is structured as follows. We begin by introducing the methodology that informs our conceptual paradigm. Following this, we delve deep into the complexities of innovation and change management. Our exploration continues with the introduction of the STRA.TECH.MAN–R.A.S.I. model, a comprehensive tool designed to navigate

the multifaceted crises that are instigating the next wave of globalization. To conclude, we underscore the theoretical and practical implications of our framework, acknowledging both the necessity for a deeper investigation in this domain and its potential applications in businesses across a variety of sectors.

2. Core components of the conceptual methodology

Drawing upon established guidelines for conceptual studies, our chapter builds on the integrative literature review method. We incorporate a "theory synthesis" approach, merging the "R.A.S.I." principles and priorities into a unified framework—a research option meticulously detailed by Jaakkola (2020) for the production of diverse conceptual articles. At the same time, we explore a comprehensive body of literature spanning macro, meso, and micro socioeconomic methodologies. Drawing from an array of diverse sources, we synthesize these viewpoints through a critical lens.

Figure 1 employs Toulmin's (1958) argumentation process to visually represent the logical flow of this core argument. Adapting Toulmin's renowned scheme for argument layout along with subsequent modifications (e.g., Verheij, 2005), the sequence of argumentation unfolds as follows: datum (facts supporting the claim), warrant (the logical bridge asserting that the data supports the claim), backing (further reinforcement for the warrant), qualifier (expressing the degree of conviction the data imparts to the claim), rebuttal (conditions under which the argument may not hold), and finally, the claim (the primary thesis being argued).

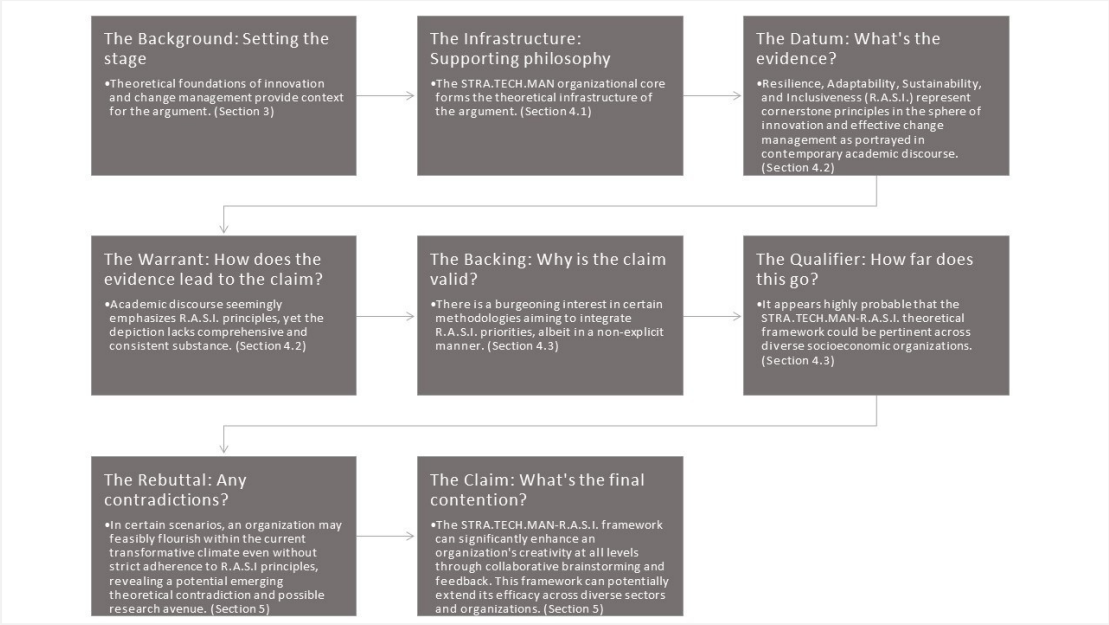


Figure 1. *The argumentation process, adapted from Toulmin's (1958) framework and correlated with our study's structure*

In Figure 1, we modify Toulmin's (1958) argumentation model to align with our study's structure, adding two novel stages: the "background" and the "infrastructure." In Section 3, we lay the groundwork with the background, establishing theoretical cornerstones of innovation and change management. Although this phase doesn't mirror any of Toulmin's components directly, it's pivotal for contextualizing our argument. The infrastructure, described in Section 4.1, embodies the organizational core of STRA.TECH.MAN. Similar to the background, this stage doesn't precisely map onto Toulmin's model, but it helps anchor our argument with its foundational philosophy.

Starting from Section 4.2, our model aligns with Toulmin's structure, delving into the "datum" or evidence. The evidence, as expounded in Section 4.2, identifies R.A.S.I. as foundational principles of effective innovation and change management as evidenced in current academic discourse. In the same section, the "warrant" underscores that though academic discourse frequently highlights the R.A.S.I principles, their portrayal lacks thoroughness and consistency. The "backing," introduced in Section 4.3, supports

the argument by highlighting the growing interest in certain methodologies that aim to subtly integrate R.A.S.I. priorities. In terms of the "qualifier," outlined in Section 4.3, there is a strong likelihood that the STRA.TECH.MAN–R.A.S.I. theoretical framework might apply across various socioeconomic organizations.

Section 5 presents the "rebuttal," acknowledging that under certain circumstances, organizations can achieve success in today's transformative climate without stringent adherence to the R.A.S.I. principles, thus revealing an emerging theoretical contradiction and a potential research opportunity. The "claim," located within the same section, concludes our argument, suggesting that the potential for the STRA.TECH.MAN–R.A.S.I. framework to bolster creativity across various organizations may be further validated through targeted examination of individual sectors and areas.

3. Innovation and change management: Essential responses to crises

In a rapidly evolving global environment fraught with various crises, it is essential for organizations to innovate and adapt in an increasingly swift and efficient manner. The capacity to pivot and transform lies at the core of their survival and growth, particularly under the fluid and pressing conditions of the contemporary world. Subsequent sections will explore the intricate nexus between crises and the need for innovation and change. We will examine the theoretical underpinnings of these vital facets of organizational development and provide a nuanced understanding of their role in managing change in conditions of crisis.

3.1. Understanding the theoretical underpinnings of innovation

All the great classical economists were primarily development theorists, examining the causes of crises generation and the potential solutions. In this regard, their work,

directly or indirectly, explicitly or implicitly, addressed the problems of innovation. Smith (1776) posited that the wealth-producing mechanism of capitalism follows a singular developmental trajectory, commencing with market growth and the continuous enhancement of productivity via labor division. According to Smith, this cycle eventually decelerates due to the declining trend in profits and investments, necessitating an openness to new technologies and markets, or in modern parlance, innovations, to reengage a cycle of growth and development.

Marx (1867) notably illuminated the field of economics with his incisive exploration into the inherent weaknesses and contradictions of capitalism. His arguments centered around the premise that an intrinsic, essential urge for global expansion permeates capitalism. Marx also attributed a defining role to the force of production, seeing it as intimately intertwined with the social sphere in a dialectical fashion. Hence, according to Marxist theory, the dynamics of both production and the encompassing innovation are pivotal to development. Metaphorically speaking, the relentless competition within capitalism and the unceasing progress of technology act as a perpetual flame, ceaselessly stoking this socioeconomic "cauldron." Marx suggested that through its "iron laws," capitalism is doomed to provoke its own explosive downfall. Therefore, despite its deterministic orientation, Marxist theory lends potent interpretive tools for grasping the importance of emerging innovation.

Schumpeter's (1942) seminal work made a significant attempt at systematically understanding the dynamics of capitalism. From his perspective, innovation serves as an embodiment of the dynamic "revolution" integral to the capitalist system. His approach, deviating from the neoclassical equilibrium-centric and quasi-static perspective, postulates that economic development incurs a significant upset of balance—aligning in some aspects with Marx's perspective. According to Schumpeter,

innovation represents the birth of a new role for the capitalist enterprise in terms of goods, production or transfer methods, inputs and intermediate materials, markets, and forms of industrial organization. Therefore, capitalism progresses via innovation, leading to the gradual obsolescence of older industries and the emergence of new ones, an eventuality Schumpeter described as “creative destruction.”

Scholars such as Freeman (1995), Perez (1983), and Porter (1990) have recently contributed further depth to this subject. Freeman proposed that a national innovation system encompasses the institutional network focused on the proliferation and development of new technologies. According to Perez, technological revolutions follow a regular cyclic pattern—surges—that include installation, deployment, and turning point periods, which correspond to shifts in the technoeconomic paradigm. Porter posited that certain nations have a competitive edge due to their hosting of more sophisticated industries, characterized by advanced production factors, demand conditions, complementary-supporting sectors, and a blend of business strategy with market structure and competition. Thus, these contemporary contributions to economic science suggest that the dynamics of innovation not only stem from entrepreneurship but also from the particular socioeconomic system of a region or country. This perspective has also sparked interest in the variety of different models of capitalism and its relevance to the international political economy (Detomasi, 2015; Dilli et al., 2018).

In administrative science, the role of innovation remains crucial.[1] The early scientific approach to management, as espoused by Taylor (1919) and his contemporaries, stressed the systematic observation and recording of work with the goal of augmenting employee productivity. This was realized through the "one best way" doctrine which entailed a heightened division of labor tasks, intensification of mechanization within the production process, and refinement of the multilevel administrative hierarchy. In this paradigm, Taylorist reasoning inferred innovation as an external dimension, envisaging the firm as a "machine" that the designer could optimize for enhanced productivity, efficiency, and thereby profitability.

Contrastingly, more contemporary theories have surfaced, conceptualizing firms as dynamic, or "living" entities. Drucker (1986, indicatively) proposed that innovation signifies a company's capacity to seize future opportunities, deliberately forsaking ineffective present-day actions and strategies. In his view, management is an essential social science. Concurrently, De Geus (1997) posited that companies falter because managers overly concentrate on the economic activity of production, neglecting the true essence of organizations—the human community. In De Geus's perspective, a firm is a living, learning, and evolving organization. Thus, innovation springs from the freedom of experimentation given to its personnel. This line of thinking is echoed by Meyer and Davis (2003), who posited that every company will inevitably decline over

[1] See the following for fundamental organizational science developments in studying innovation: Anzola-Román et al. (2018), Belasco (1991), Christensen (1997), Ciobanu et al. (2018), Crossan and Apaydin (2010), Ghoshal and Bartlett (2000), Hamdoun et al. (2018), Hamel (2002), Hamel and Prahalad (1994), Handy (2003), Moss Kanter (2013), Kim and Mauborgne (2015), Kimberly and Evanisko (1981), Markides and Geroski (2004), Porter (1980), and Rondi et al. (2019).

time, necessitating the leadership to rescue current value by transforming the firm's ideas and people to bolster productivity.

Similarly, Hammer and Champy (1993) advocated for a thorough reevaluation of the firm's operations, fostering a deeper pursuit for novel organizational work standards based on "why something occurs" rather than "how." From this viewpoint, given the accelerated life cycles of products and services, firms must adapt swiftly. The true locus of innovation lies in the structural operational processes of the business.

In sum, the landscape of innovation theory has substantially evolved, weaving a tapestry that stretches from the principles of classical economics to the current-day administrative science. It becomes increasingly evident that innovation is not only crucial for economic growth and competitive vigor, but it is also an essential facet of an organization's structure, operations, and overall approach to management.

3.2. Defining the fundamentals of change management

Change management inherently involves any alteration that necessitates an individual, group, or organization to transition from one set of activities and behaviors to another. Despite its vital role in spurring innovation, managing change as a discipline seems to lack definitive methodological requirements. This results in a fusion of various conceptual paradigms from diverse fields such as management, business strategy, economics, sociology, and psychology (Burnes, 2009).

An exploration of the theoretical foundations of change management reveals a gradual shift from traditional to more contemporary theoretical models of

management.[2] In this evolving perspective, organizations are viewed as "living entities," with employees having unique emotional and communication needs. Additionally, decision-making processes frequently contend with incomplete information and limited cognitive capacity for their effective analysis (Vlados & Chatzinikolaou, 2019). A particularly influential method is Total Quality Management (refer to Deming 1982, Juran 1995), which emphasizes the continual refinement of the organization through active participation from all members, directing every organizational facet and action towards the long-term advantage of the customer.

Nonaka and Takeuchi (1995) argued that corporate success is driven by a company's capacity to learn, predicated on the synthesis of tacit and explicit organizational knowledge. Absent effective mechanisms for absorbing and disseminating expertise within the organization—and without fostering an environment conducive to innovation—efforts at change management are futile. Likewise, Senge (1990) underscored unique organizational learning arenas critical to the "dance of change." According to Senge, a systems-level perspective is necessary today to facilitate change, as organizational adjustments are invariably multi-tiered and intricate.

Drawing a parallel, Goss et al. (1993) proposed the concept of organizational reinvention as a method of managing change. They suggested that organizations need not alter their inherent identity, but instead, give birth to something novel. Another influential change management theory is Kotter's (1996), which introduced leadership

[2] See also the following for impactful organizational science developments in studying change management: By (2005), Covey (1989), Cummings et al. (2016), Duck (1993), Martin (1993), Rosenbaum et al. (2018), Samuel et al. (2015), Schaffer and Thomson (1992), Sirkin et al. (2005), and Van der Voet (2014).

principles and delineated a sequence of steps that all organizations can employ to adapt to the inevitable need for change—a need that is rapidly accelerating in today's world. These steps include revising the vision, adopting a fresh strategy, and embedding new methods into the organization's ethos.

Kotler and Caslione (2009) have also made significant contributions to the study of change management, proposing a thorough restructuring of organizational strategies in response to the severe crises and chaotic conditions impacting the global landscape. In their view, the world system will henceforth generate conditions of chaos and uncertainty, and businesses must therefore strategically adapt to this chaos by capitalizing on their competitors' weaknesses and adopting proactive, rather than reactive, management and marketing strategies. Echoing this approach, Vlados (2017) offered a sequence of change management steps, such as constructing a new vision, charting a revised strategic path, realigning technology, revamping management, and executing a "strategy-technology-management" synthesis that ultimately yields all types of innovation, and assimilating the ensuing transformation.

Ultimately, the realm of change management explores how organizations can seamlessly traverse the complexities of transitions, thereby allowing them to adapt to ever-changing business environments and tackle emergent challenges. The ideological shift from traditional to modern management thinking emphasizes the necessity to perceive organizations as "living entities," as dynamic participants within the business ecosystems they inhabit, requiring constant learning and adaptation (McMullen, 2018). Hence, effective change management hinges on the ability to cultivate an environment that fosters both organizational learning and innovation.

4. STRA.TECH.MAN–R.A.S.I. synthesis: A framework for navigating the crisis

In the current phase of globalization, characterized by sustained crises and significant restructuring initiatives (Vlados & Chatzinikolaou, 2021), there is a conspicuous absence of comprehensive methodologies offering holistic conceptual frameworks for innovation and change management applicable across all socioeconomic organizations. The STRA.TECH.MAN–R.A.S.I. approach, proposed herein, aims to fill this gap.

4.1. The STRA.TECH.MAN organizational core

As per Vlados (2004), the synthesis of strategy, technology, and management constitutes the vital core of any "living organization." The STRA.TECH.MAN approach proposes that these foundational and intrinsic facets drive the innovation within any socioeconomic entity, thereby enabling its competitive endurance and progress in the perpetually transforming external environment (Figure 2).

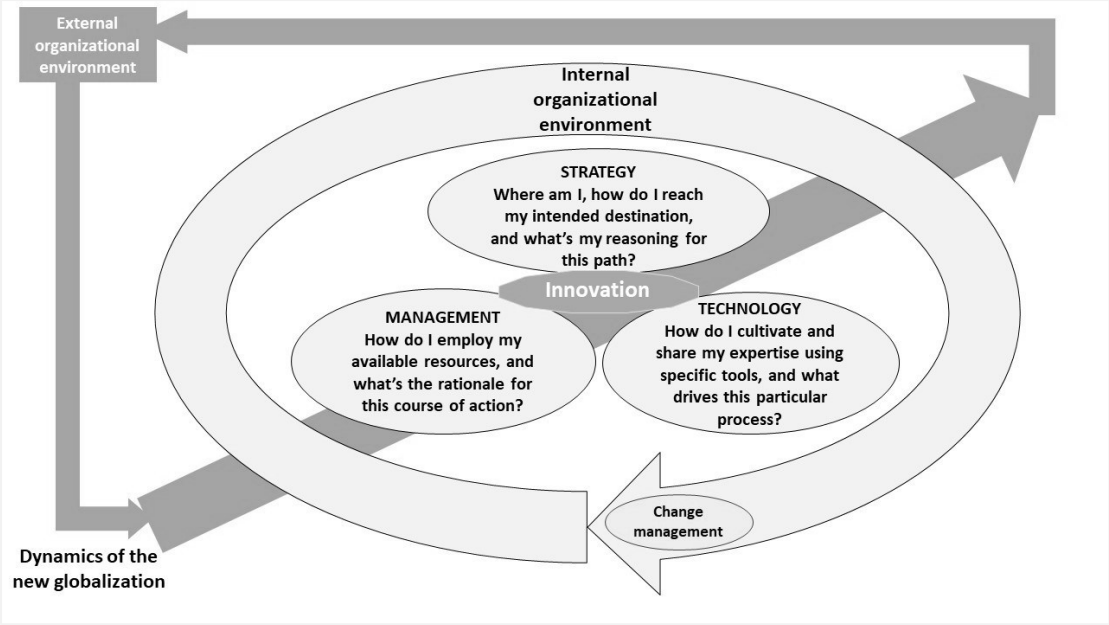


Figure 2: *The STRA.TECH.MAN approach, inspired by Vlados (2004)*

These three dimensions emanate from a series of deep-seated inquiries that elucidate the rationale and evolutionary physiology of organizational actions.[3] Strategy pertains to "Where am I, how do I reach my intended destination, and what's my reasoning for this path?" Technology involves "How do I cultivate and share my expertise using specific tools, and what drives this particular process?" Management ponders over "How do I employ my available resources, and what's the rationale for this course of action?" These constituents shape the unique and constantly evolving STRA.TECH.MAN dynamic triangle of any enterprise, regardless of its size, nature, or industry. Drawing a biological parallel, this synthesis represents the inherent "organic" identity or "DNA" of each socioeconomic organization. In this perspective, business innovation alters the external environment, and the subsequent transformation triggers

[3] Empirical studies that have effectively utilized the Stra.Tech.Man approach include, but are not limited to, the works of Chatzinikolaou and Vlados (2022), Falaras and Moschidis (2021), and Vlados and Chatzinikolaou (2019).

a feedback into the affected organizational system. Consequently, change management acts as the adaptive mechanism in response to the evolution incited by innovation. A key postulate of this approach is that the STRA.TECH.MAN core can decipher all socioeconomic organizations irrespective of their geographical location or "spatial" level as it is termed. Specifically, the term "spatial" conveys the idea that the STRA.TECH.MAN core can be applied to socioeconomic organizations located anywhere geographically.

4.2. Introducing the STRA.TECH.MAN–R.A.S.I. model

Building on the organization's STRA.TECH.MAN framework, we introduce the dimensions of the R.A.S.I. model. These dimensions—Resilience, Adaptability, Sustainability, and Inclusiveness—coalesce the essential elements of innovation and change management, which are seen as indispensable for any organization under the prevailing global restructuring conditions (World Economic Forum, 2018). A closer examination, which we will embark upon shortly, reveals that these four dimensions are frequently perceived as interdependent and co-determinant in contemporary literature. Yet, it appears none of them fully embody or articulate these four dimensions in a comprehensive manner. We offer Table 1 to illustrate key definitions of organizational resilience drawn from recent literature.

Table 1: *Resilience definitions and key concepts*

Author	Definition	Key concept
Al-Atwi et al. (2021, p. 4)	The capability of a company to withstand, recover from or adapt to sudden emergencies threatening its existence is referred to as organizational resilience. This ability offers insights into maintaining achievement of company goals during unexpected events and crises, which are major barriers to adaptation.	Ability to maintain goal achievement during crises
Börekçi et al. (2021, p. 424)	Organizational resilience is seen as the system's ability to bounce back and innovate in the face of unexpected, stress-inducing, and detrimental situations affecting its operations.	System's ability to recover and innovate during adversity
Chen et al. (2021, p. 19)	Organizational resilience is the capacity of a firm to adjust its resources, enhance its processes, transform its relationships during a crisis, recuperate swiftly from the	Leveraging crisis for counter-trend growth

	crisis, and leverage the crisis to attain growth against the odds.	
Ererdi et al. (2021, p. 15)	The capacity of corporations to withstand serious economic hardships is what organizational resilience stands for. For resilience, organizations must concentrate on honing dynamic capabilities and cultivating a flexible workforce.	Focus on dynamic capabilities and workforce agility
Hajishirzi et al. (2022, p. 3)	Organizational resilience speaks to a firm's reaction to potential obliteration, emphasizing its ability to recover, grow, and persevere amidst adversity, crisis, or disaster. It highlights a firm's capacity to adapt, evolve, and endure in a dynamic environment. Organizations must shift their culture and become more agile to achieve resilience. Resilient businesses center their strategies on deciding their future business type and how to gain a competitive advantage to reach that future.	Adaptability, expansion, and survival amidst changing environment
Li (2020, p. 503)	The distinctive capability of an organization to anticipate, address, and learn from adversities, including crisis events, in order to recover in the short term and thrive over time, is termed organizational resilience.	Capability to anticipate, respond, and learn from adverse events
Sreenivasan et al. (2022, p. 1)	Organizational resilience is the measure of a company's readiness to withstand or react to a crisis. Major global events, like the COVID-19 pandemic, global crisis of 2008, among others, resulted in an amplified focus on investigating the resilience concept. These catastrophic events drove companies to reassess their business practices to better deal with the fallout of unpredicted and sudden disruptions.	Readiness for crisis and ability to reassess business practices

The definitions help elucidate organizational resilience as the firm's ability to effectively respond to unprecedented and stressful events. The focal point is the extent to which the organization recovers from such a crisis. We propose that resilience is intertwined with the other dimensions in the R.A.S.I. model. Table 2 showcases definitions of adaptability from recent relevant literature.

Table 2: *Adaptability definitions and key concepts*

Author	**Definition**	**Key concept**
Askarova (2021, p. 180)	In essence, research implies that organizational adaptability goes beyond a mere collection of dynamic capabilities. For efficacy, these capabilities need to be coordinated as a complete enterprise ability that fosters an adaptable, cooperative, inclusive, and transparent setting for change.	Holistic enterprise capacity for change
Fan et al. (2020, p. 2)	Organizational adaptability denotes companies' ongoing, deliberate efforts to scrutinize the environment with the intent to leverage opportunities, foresee costs and risks, thereby outperforming competitors. On the other hand, organizational inflexibility builds upon the assumption that competitive advantage-forming routines risk becoming "core rigidities," or sources of competitive drawbacks when firms interact with environmental changes.	Ability to scan environment, leverage opportunities, and anticipate risks
Khalil and Nabil (2021, p. 218)	Every organization faces the challenge of adapting to its environment. Hence, a critical strategy for enhancing	Learning from incidents and failures

	organizational adaptability is the development of the capability to learn from incidents and failures.	
McClellan (2021, pp. 85–86)	Organizational adaptability is defined by a fundamental balance between the need to innovate and the requirement to produce. Adaptability arises from the interface of these tensions and is linked to novel organizational structures. These structures or processes are versatile and fluid. The adaptability process involves transitioning organizations from one state to another to improve their fit with the environment. This adaptability process relies on knowledge, learning, and information flows (e.g., knowledge transfer, knowledge spillovers) enabling the creation and emergence of novelty.	Balance between innovation and production
Wick (2021, p. 28)	Organizational adaptability is a strategy for organizations to endure disruptions and potentially flourish at the brink of chaos.	Enduring disruptions and thriving in chaos
Zhang et al. (2021, p. 4)	Organizational adaptability is the pivotal component for the survival of an organization. It encompasses a company's ability to adjust to both internal and external environments.	Adjusting to internal and external environments

These definitions highlight organizational adaptability as the firm's capability to survive persistent changes in the external environment by capitalizing on emerging opportunities and mitigating potential threats. Learning and "relearning" also play a critical role in assessing an organization's adaptability. We posit that this adaptability is intertwined with the other dimensions in the R.A.S.I. model. Table 3 collates definitions that elucidate sustainability as an organizational skill.

Table 3: *Sustainability definitions and key concepts*

Author	Definition	Key concept
Buhusayen et al. (2021, p. 2)	Sustainable organizations overcome distinct difficulties by picking the right strategies, people, and leadership to ensure persistent performance. Despite the unparalleled speed and extent of changes during the COVID-19 pandemic, it offers a chance to draw essential and broad learnings from how organizations react to significant changes.	Overcoming challenges through change strategies
Kilintzis et al. (2020, p. 950)	Organizational sustainability is directly tied to sustainable development. Increased sustainability in an organization might be achieved through deeper understanding of sharing matters, archiving knowledge, fostering social interactions for knowledge exchange, targeting innovation, and striving for superior performance.	Connection between sustainability and knowledge sharing
Mohiuddin et al. (2022, p. 1)	Organizational sustainability involves addressing the immediate and indirect needs of stakeholders, while also considering the future requirements of potential stakeholders.	Stakeholders' demands
Onyama (2021, p. 1)	Organizational sustainability is about providing organizations with the necessary human resources and structures for success in the international business environment of the 21st century.	Equipping organizations with necessary resources

Vargas-Hernández and Orozco Quijano (2022, pp. 19–20)	As the business world and society undergo rapid changes in the new global economy, organizational sustainability is facing a crisis. Businesses encounter new prospects and challenges as they progress towards sustainable development at their own rhythm.	Dealing with rapid dynamic changes

Sustainability pertains to the urgent issues that a firm must address considering potential significant future changes in the external environment. It refers to the unique capabilities an organization develops over time to remain viable in the long run, not merely today. From this perspective, we contend that organizational sustainability relates to the other three R.A.S.I. dimensions. Table 4 compiles key definitions suggesting that inclusiveness is a pivotal strategy for tackling today's global crisis and restructuring.

Table 4: *Inclusiveness definitions and key concepts*

Author	**Definition**	**Key concept**
Aga Khan Foundation Portugal et al. (2021, p. 6)	Organizations that persist in their dedication to Diversity and Inclusion (D&I) are better equipped to withstand difficulties and rebound from crises, leveraging their innovative and creative capacities. They can grow and rejuvenate themselves by continuously attracting diverse talents. Inclusive organizations are also recognized for their increased resilience and significant contribution to societal harmony.	Resilience and societal cohesion
Das (2021, pp. 83–84)	D&I leaders who guide their organizations towards a brighter future and improved culture with the ultimate aim of transformation foster a deeper sense of cooperation and goodwill both internally and externally with their clients and communities.	Transformation towards an improved culture
Day (2021, p. 30)	Inclusive culture embodies the integration of diverse individuals into a mutually respectful and accepting environment that appreciates and acknowledges their unique contributions to the organization's success.	Integration of diverse individuals
Kuknor and Bhattacharya (2021, p. 107)	Embracing diversity in the new workplace and fostering an inclusive environment can be a proactive approach to address employees' concerns. This study is pioneering in illustrating how an inclusive workplace can positively influence organizational outcomes and underscores the importance of leadership in crisis times.	Importance of leadership in promoting diversity
Linkov et al. (2022, p. 4)	Inclusiveness is characterized as (i) covering a wide array of subjects or areas, and (ii) the principle or practice of granting equal access to opportunities and resources for those who might otherwise be marginalized, like those with physical or mental disabilities or those belonging to minority groups.	Providing equal access to opportunities and resources

These recent fundamental approaches to inclusiveness reveal that it is organizational leadership who is ultimately responsible for permeating a culture that is indifferent to

deviations from the norm. They underscore that a diverse culture can spur creativity and enhance performance. Moreover, successful organizational development results from a culture of mutual respect that permeates among all stakeholders, including customers, employees, and the administration.

Though the literature increasingly applies these concepts in the new globalization context, few approaches integrate all R.A.S.I. dimensions. Integration of these dimensions means their co-dependent consideration and application in understanding and responding to organizational challenges. A few recent approaches hint at the combined usage of these terms, as illustrated below:

- World Economic Forum (2018, p. 4): "*... we define agile governance as adaptive, human-centred, inclusive and sustainable policymaking, which acknowledges that policy development is no longer limited to governments but rather is an increasingly multistakeholder effort. It is the continual readiness to rapidly navigate change, proactively or reactively embrace change and learn from change, while contributing to actual or perceived end-user value.*"
- World Economic Forum (2019, p. 9): "*Values-based leadership (personal and organizational) is increasingly needed to help leaders navigate the complex issues populating the headlines today, including the responsible use of artificial intelligence; the appropriate and ethical use of people's data; an obligation to create a more diverse and inclusive workplace; gender parity; a commitment to sustainability and the larger community in which mankind works and lives; and the role of truth, trust and transparency in the workplace.*"
- Linz (2020): "*Smart leaders make sure that ... their transformation initiatives are focused on new business models and ideally drive new digital native revenue streams. In a disrupted world, they invest in strategic resilience and focus on*

inclusive–comprehensive and sticky— business models like platforms and solutions."

These recent views indicate an increasing trend of the shared application of these terms. Consequently, we observe that in the new era of globalization, all R.A.S.I. dimensions interrelate and complement each other in an evolutionary and constantly transforming way of synthesis. Essentially, we believe that the response to the requirements of the new globalization demands an integrated approach of the four R.A.S.I. dimensions. The R.A.S.I. model, as a part of the broader STRA.TECH.MAN framework, promotes an innovative synthesis that each organization can achieve, given its direct connection to the organization's aspiration to invigorate its inherent creativity (Grohman & Snyder, 2022). Literature focusing on the shifting dynamics of organizations in this new phase of globalization emphasizes the necessity for a comprehensive grasp of the internal organizational environment (Koutroukis et al., 2022), enabling companies to maintain and boost their competitiveness.

4.3. Operationalizing the STRA.TECH.MAN–R.A.S.I. scorecard

The rising need for practical models in the new global landscape that effectively help all types of organizations articulate their innovation is addressed by the STRA.TECH.MAN scorecard. This pioneering approach furthers the trajectory of the strategy-technology-management synthesis and is implemented in the form of a scorecard approach (Figure 3).

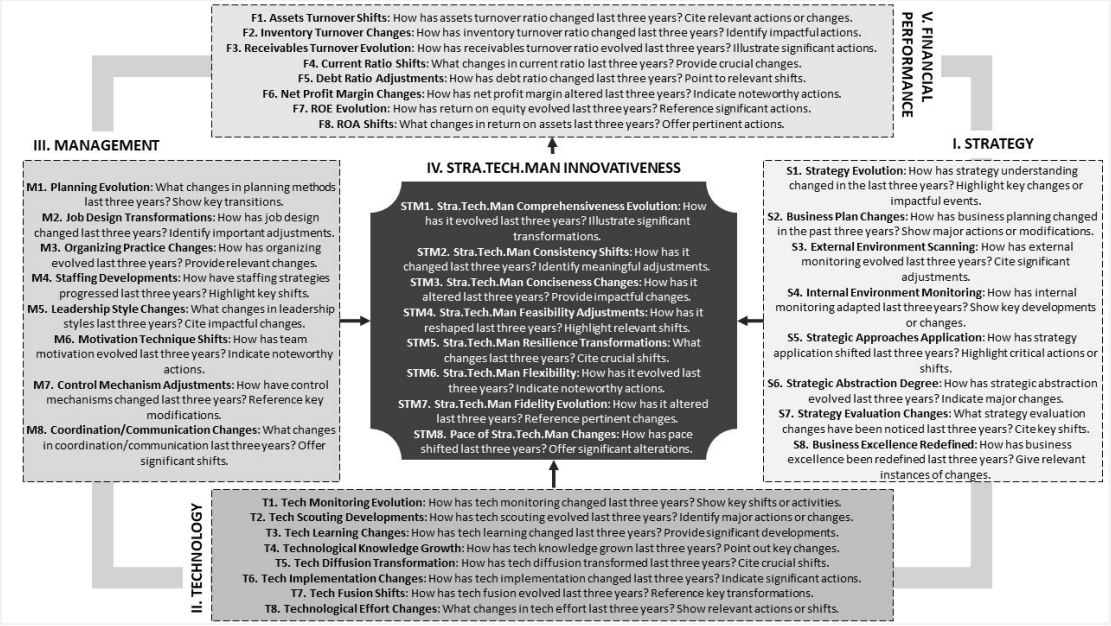


Figure 3: *The STRA.TECH.MAN scorecard, based on Vlados (2021)*

Featuring the capability to evaluate 40 dimensions-questions reflective of a firm's organizational physiology, this cutting-edge consulting tool could be a useful resource for an organization looking to confront its weaknesses and pathogenies, whilst also recognizing its comparative strengths and the apexes of its competitiveness. Unlike other tools that predominantly target large, structurally complex organizations (cf. Kaplan & Norton, 1996), the STRA.TECH.MAN scorecard approach embraces organizations of all scales. It offers a holistic perspective of the evolution of business physiology, unhampered by constraints related to size, structure, and measurement capabilities, as its questions bear relevance to all organizations, thereby offering a comprehensive overview of an organization's developmental control (Vlados, 2021).

The approach promotes self-evaluation and action research by mapping changes over time in areas like the organization's strategy, technology, management, innovativeness, and financial performance (Eden & Ackermann, 2018; Lewin, 1946). Factors are rated on a five Likert scale from -2 to +2, which correlate with high potential for weakness or strength. Respondents fill in their perceptions of the last three years

and the present, the aggregate of which, alongside professional consultant interpretation, results in the final audit. Each question is coupled with a brief explanation based on international literature to aid in self-evaluation. Respondents are also prompted to substantiate their answers with open-ended explanations.

In simpler terms, the STRA.TECH.MAN scorecard functions as a recurring audit that utilizes perspectives from the organization's executives and external consultants to pinpoint pathogenic and creative areas. It aims to provide an overall insight into the organization's trajectory through self-assessments, allowing comparison of self-monitored information with a standard or goal (Zimmerman, 2000, p. 21). For optimal efficacy, we recommend annual audits. Any deviations in the results should be promptly addressed through intra-business brainstorming and problem-solving, ensuring consistent evaluation of the organization's overall trajectory.

Layering the R.A.S.I. approach onto this organizational audit tool introduces four additional dimensions that facilitate organizational innovation and change management. Figure 4 illustrates this composite scorecard.

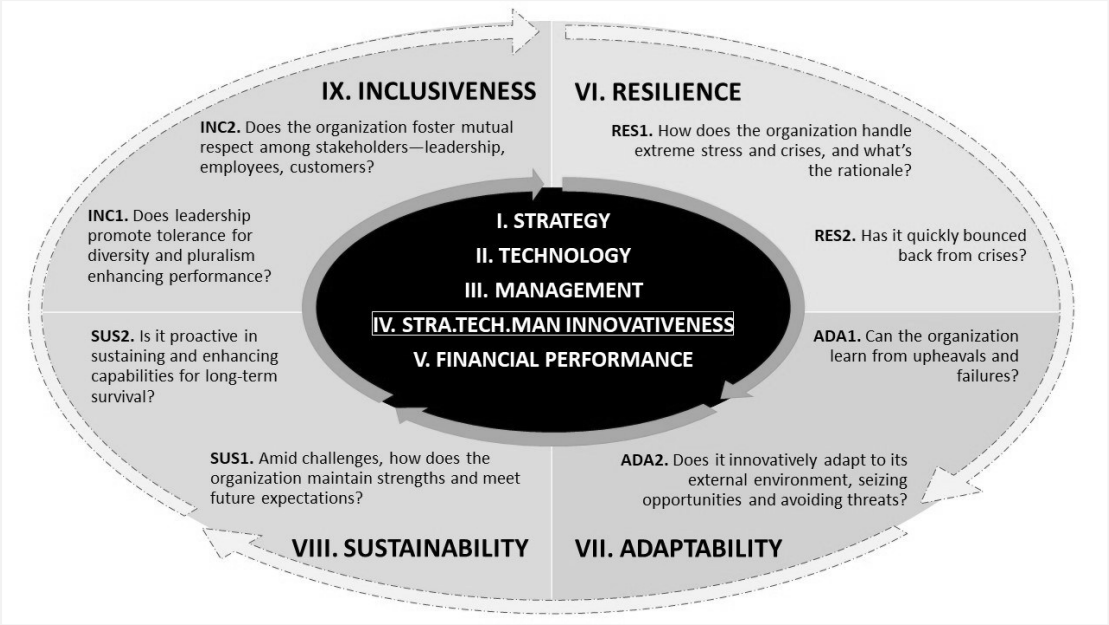


Figure 4: *The STRA.TECH.MAN–R.A.S.I. scorecard*

This enhanced tool incorporates two questions for each examined dimension. Guided by definitions we've previously outlined, we propose eight crucial questions for the four R.A.S.I. dimensions as follows:

- Resilience: (1) How does the organization handle extreme stress and crises, and what's the rationale? (2) Has it quickly bounced back from crises?
- Adaptability: (1) Can the organization learn from upheavals and failures? (2) Does it innovatively adapt to its external environment, seizing opportunities and avoiding threats?[4]
- Sustainability: (1) Amid challenges, how does the organization maintain strengths and meet future expectations? (2) Is it proactive in sustaining and enhancing capabilities for long-term survival?

[4] For this question, see also Vlados (2019a) for a "correlative SWOT analysis," which suggests that the opportunities and threats of the external environment result always from the firm's particular strengths and weaknesses.

- ❖ Inclusiveness: (1) Does leadership promote tolerance for diversity and pluralism enhancing performance? (2) Does the organization foster mutual respect among stakeholders—leadership, employees, customers?

With the consolidated definitions provided in Tables 1 to 4 serving as a theoretical foundation, an initial diagnosis can be conducted. Armed with this foundational understanding, the consultant—or "firm's doctor"—can perform a preliminary review of the organization's potential to articulate an innovative business model under prevailing conditions.

In conclusion, the STRA.TECH.MAN–R.A.S.I. scorecard operationalizes the intricate dynamics of innovation and change management in a practical manner. It enables organizations to understand and map their resilience, adaptability, sustainability, and inclusiveness as core assets of organizational survival. The aim is not only to provide a snapshot of an organization's current state but also to chart its evolution and adaptation over time.

Moving forward, this robust scorecard, which integrates key facets of organizational development, could be a foundational source for leaders, managers, and consultants, acting as a compass in navigating the complex dynamics of the new global landscape.

5. Conclusion, constraints, and future prospects

The focus of this study was to introduce the STRA.TECH.MAN-R.A.S.I. scorecard, a novel mapping instrument designed to pinpoint both the strengths and weaknesses in organizations' development. By aiming to augment the capacity and capability of innovation and change management within organizations, the tool's framework propels businesses to confront critical inquiries and better prepare for the intricate demands of the emerging global landscape.

The model's relevance is particularly noteworthy during times of crisis, as demonstrated during the COVID-19 pandemic and the Russo-Ukrainian conflict. Both these events accelerated the move towards the fourth industrial revolution and energy transition, respectively (Menu & Repko, 2022; Schwab & Malleret, 2020). The scorecard reinforces Resilience, Adaptability, Sustainability, and Inclusiveness within organizations, which appear to better equip them to counteract these challenges, enhancing their prospects for success amid escalating global uncertainty. Although the STRA.TECH.MAN–R.A.S.I. scorecard does not purport to be universally applicable to every crisis scenario, it centers on current transition crisis priorities and invites exploration of other key determinants of organizational success.

However, the potential for organizations to thrive in this transformative environment without adhering strictly to R.A.S.I principles suggests an interesting theoretical discrepancy and potential future research direction.

It is vital to recognize that the crisis management viewpoint presented in this paper should not adopt a short-term or situational approach to the burgeoning realities of the new globalization era. The STRA.TECH.MAN–R.A.S.I. framework proposes a structural perspective, focusing on long-term, systemic issues that could potentially precipitate crises, as opposed to a conjunctural approach that emphasizes immediate crisis-triggering factors (Vlados et al., 2018).

The essence of the STRA.TECH.MAN-R.A.S.I. framework is that, through collaborative brainstorming and constructive feedback, it can substantially boost an organization's creative potential at individual, team, and organizational levels. This framework, driven by principles of participatory interactive communication, can transform the process of organizational mapping into a creativity catalyst (Leroy et al., 2022).

Despite showing promise in navigating through the current crisis of the new globalization, the effectiveness of the STRA.TECH.MAN–R.A.S.I. framework necessitates further empirical exploration across different sectors and regions. This highlights the need for research to both authenticate its practical value and enhance its components, thereby broadening its functionality and adaptability to various organizational environments.

Additionally, our diagnostic framework could serve as a bedrock for the creation of policies that stimulate entrepreneurship and facilitate socioeconomic development. Therefore, the continuous refinement of our understanding of innovation and change management amid the crisis of the new globalization presents an intriguing opportunity for further scholarly pursuit and practical application in this domain.

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Short bios

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